צְדָקַת הַצַּדִּיק

TZIDKAS HATZADDIK

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Volume I · Sections 1–170

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin

Akiva Publishing · 2026

Tzidkas HaTzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition · Volume I · Sections 1–170

This volume presents sections 1–170 of Tzidkas HaTzaddik in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in numbered footnotes.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

Original work צדקת הצדיק by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

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Published by Akiva Publishing · Two-volume interlinear edition, 2026

בְּסַיְעָתָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא — **With the help of Heaven.**

קוּנְטְרֵס קָרָאתִיו צִדְקַת הַצַּדִּיק בִּשְׁנַת "צַדִּקוֹת אָהֵב"[1] [2] — **A pamphlet I have entitled Tzidkat HaTzadik [The Righteousness of the Righteous], in the year "He loves righteousness" (Psalms 11:7) — 5608 [1848].**

Siman 1

Entering Divine Service in Haste

[א] רֵאשִׁית כְּנִיסַת הָאָדָם לַעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת בְּחִפָּזוֹן,[3,4,5] — **The initial entry of a person into the service of God must be done in haste,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּפֶסַח מִצְרַיִם שֶׁהָיָה נֶאֱכָל בְּחִפָּזוֹן, וְלֹא פֶּסַח דּוֹרוֹת.[6] — **just as we find regarding the Passover of Egypt, which was eaten in haste, whereas the Passover of subsequent**

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[1] **Ezekiel 18:20**: 'The soul that sins is the one that will die. A son will not bear his father's guilt, nor will a father bear his son's guilt. The righteousness of the righteous person will remain his own, and the wickedness of the wicked person will remain his own.'

[2] **Psalms 11:7**: 'For Hashem is righteous and loves righteous deeds; the upright will behold His face.'

[3] **Exodus 12:11**: 'This is how you shall eat it: with your belts fastened, your shoes on your feet, and your staffs in your hands. Eat it in haste; it is a Pesach offering to Hashem.'

[4] **Haste at the beginning and deliberation afterward**

The initial awakening must be seized before the desires that bind a person overwhelm it. After that first departure, service proceeds with a slower, deliberate pace.

Kisvei Rav Tzadok · Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Dover Tzedek, Berakhot 2:3: "Afterward, "to learn and to teach": first one receives from his teachers, then still more from his colleagues, as is taught in Ta'anit 7a—this is "to learn"; and from his students more than from them all—this is "to teach." These correspond to the passages "You shall love" and "And it shall be, if you listen," as is taught in Berakhot 14b. Afterward, "to guard": this is the reflection before an action comes into practice, from the expression "His father kept [the matter]," which signifies waiting. As is written in Asarah Ma'amarot, a mitzvah requires watchfulness and waiting so that one can prepare oneself, while the zealous act early lest death overtake them. This corresponds to "So that your days may be many." After one has passed through all these levels, he should then be deliberate, for he is assured of "so that they may be many": life will increase, and his desire will not cease after a time. At the beginning it is different. When a desire reaches him, he must act upon it promptly, lest the desire cease in the meantime. As we have written elsewhere concerning the Passover offering in Egypt, it is eaten in haste while one has not yet passed through the preceding levels."

Explanation: Dover Tzedek locates this transition within the sequence "to learn, to teach, to guard, to do, and to establish." It explains how patient preparation can become appropriate once the earlier stages have steadied the desire. This gives a fuller account of the deliberation with which Tzidkat HaTzadik concludes.

[5] **Seizing the first awakening, then proceeding patiently**

The opening of Tzidkat HaTzadik distinguishes the urgency needed to leave an old attachment from the measured work that follows. The first moment must become a willingness to follow God, while later growth has its own pace.

Kisvei Rav Tzadok · Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Nisan 2:1: "The first commandment was the eating of the paschal offerings: to eat sacred meat, so that holiness would enter every Israelite through it. The commandment given concerning it was: "This is how you shall eat it—your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand." Why did they need this, when the eating took place at night and the departure from Egypt by day? Rather, this was the preparation of being ready to follow the LORD: "your following Me into the wilderness." This is the meaning of "the right foot": the work of this month is to be ready to follow the LORD, "to walk in His ways." This is accepting the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven, represented by the final letter heh, kingship."

Explanation: Peri Tzadik asks why the Israelites ate ready for travel although their departure would occur only later. Readiness itself was their first acceptance of Heaven's rule. This gives substance to Tzidkat HaTzadik's initial haste: the decisive moment is used to orient oneself toward following God, before the journey has been completed. It also helps explain why the urgency of the beginning need not dictate the pace of everything that follows.

Kisvei Ishbitz–Radzin · Sod Yesharim, The First Night of Pesach 25:1: "All this indicates that, in a situation where Israel clearly recognizes His blessed will, they no longer attend to any established order, but have the capacity to leap without proceeding through gradual stages, acting with great alacrity to do His blessed will. This is the meaning of: "The Passover offering that our ancestors would eat—for what reason? Because the Holy One, blessed be He, passed over." That is, why were they commanded to undertake such intense service? "Because the Holy One, blessed be He, passed over the houses of our ancestors in Egypt": because the Holy One, blessed be He, also leapt over, and shone salvation upon us by a leap, in haste, before the appointed time. Therefore we too were commanded, and it was fixed in our hearts, to perform such service in a short time and with great alacrity."

Explanation: Sod Yesharim explains why Pesach can require a leap past ordinary stages: clearly recognized Divine will calls forth swift service, answering the salvation that arrived by a leap. This illuminates why Rav Tzadok treats the awakening as an opportunity that can be lost through delay. Tzidkat HaTzadik supplies the further distinction in this pair: after the initial departure, service proceeds slowly and deliberately. The comparison does not turn every impulse into authorization to skip stages.

generations was not. מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַהִתְחָלָה לְנַתֵּק עַצְמוֹ מִכָּל תַּאֲווֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה שֶׁהוּא מְקֻשָּׁר בָּהֶם,[7] **— Because at the start of tearing oneself away from all the physical desires of this world to which one is bound,** צָרִיךְ לִשְׁמֹר הָרֶגַע שֶׁמִּתְעוֹרֵר בּוֹ רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם, **— one must seize the precise moment in which an awakening to the will of God occurs,** וְלַחְפּוֹז עַל אוֹתוֹ רֶגַע לְמַהֵר לָצֵאת מֵהֶם, אוּלַי יוּכַל. **— and rush upon that very moment to hasten an escape from them, so that perhaps one may succeed.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ שׁוּב יֵלֵךְ בְּמְתִינוּת וּלְאַט, כְּדִין פֶּסַח דּוֹרוֹת. **— And afterward he should go on slowly and deliberately, like the law governing the Passover of later generations.**

Siman 2

Blessings and Awareness of the Divine

לְכָךְ מַסֶּכֶת בְּרָכוֹת הִיא הַפְּתִיחָה לְכָל הַתַּלְמוּד. בְּרָכוֹת לְרֹאשׁ צַדִּיק.[8] [ב] **— "Blessings are upon the head of the righteous" (Proverbs 10:6).** הַהַתְחָלָה מִשִּׁשָּׁה סְדָרִים, **— For this reason, Tractate Berakhot [Blessings] is the opening treatise of the entire Talmud (the Six Orders),** וְאַחַר כָּךְ "וְעָבְדֵהוּ",[9] "דַּע אֶת אֱלֹהֵי אָבִיךָ וְעָבְדֵהוּ". שֶׁעִקַּר הַכֹּל: **— because the foundation of everything is: "Know the God of your father" (I Chronicles 28:9) — and only afterward, "and serve Him",** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לֵידַע לְמִי עוֹבֵד. **— for one must first know Whom one is serving.** הַבְּרָכָה לְפָנֵי כָּל מַעֲשֶׂה, לְיַחֵד כָּל מַעֲשָׂיו לַשֵּׁם,[10] **— And this is the purpose of reciting a blessing before every action: to dedicate all of one's deeds to God,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "בְּכָל דְּרָכֶיךָ דָּעֵהוּ",[11] [רַבֵּנוּ מֹשֶׁה בֶּן [12]

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[6] **Pesachim 96a:24**: ““You shall eat it in haste”: that one is eaten in haste, but no other [Paschal offering] is eaten in haste.”

Context: The discussion distinguishes the first Passover in Egypt from later Passovers. Rav Tzadok applies that distinction to spiritual beginnings: the first break with one’s former course calls for haste; the subsequent course can proceed deliberately.

[7] **Tanya, Part I; Likkutei Amarim 31:14-16**: “This condition is the condition of the Exodus from Egypt, of which it is said, ‘For the people fled.’ At first sight this is puzzling: why was it so? Had they told Pharaoh to release them forever, would he not have been compelled to release them? Rather, the evil in the souls of Israel was still at full strength in the left chamber, for their impurity did not cease until the giving of the Torah. Their aim and desire were only that their divine soul should leave the exile of the other side, which is the impurity of Egypt, and cleave to Him, blessed be He. As it is written, ‘Hashem, my strength, my stronghold, and my refuge in a day of distress,’ and so forth; ‘my stronghold and my refuge,’ and so forth; ‘He is a refuge for me,’ and so forth. Therefore, in the future, when Hashem removes the spirit of impurity from the earth, it is written, ‘You shall not go in flight, for Hashem goes before you,’ and so forth.”

[8] **Proverbs 10:6**: ‘Blessings rest upon the head of the righteous, but violence will cover the mouth of the wicked.’

[9] **I Chronicles 28:9**: ‘And you, Solomon my son, know the God of your father and serve Him with a whole heart and a willing soul. For Hashem searches every heart and understands every inclination of thought. If you seek Him, He will let you find Him; if you abandon Him, He will cast you off forever.’

[10] **A blessing redirects the life received from food toward its Giver**

Sod Yesharim follows the blessing through eating to the use of the strength that the food supplies.

Kisvei Ishbitz–Radzin · Sod Yesharim, Simchat Torah 1:2: “At the beginning we bless, “Who brings bread forth from the earth,” as the Sages said in Berakhot: “Ha-motzi means ‘who brought forth.’” Blessing is also an expression of drawing forth: one draws to oneself the utterance of God’s mouth clothed within the food. As it is written, “For a person does not live by bread alone, but by everything that proceeds from God’s mouth.” The blessed will that, from the creation of the world, brings into being and gives life to everything in the world is clothed within the bread and gives life to the person. Through the blessing, the person breaks through the garments and finds and draws forth to himself the blessed will that gives him life. Before eating, at the time of the blessing, the person gives to the food, for through the blessing the food is raised. But at the time of eating, the food is called the giver, because the person is nourished by it. After eating, the person prevails over the food, because the choice is then in his hands: according to the way he serves God with the strength of that eating, so will be the ascent of that food.”

Explanation: Sod Yesharim develops the present siman’s instruction to dedicate one’s deeds to Hashem through the blessing. Recognition before eating uncovers the divine will within the food, but the account continues afterward: the person chooses how to serve Hashem with the received strength. Knowing before Whom one blesses thus begins a relationship that governs the ensuing action; it is more than an acknowledgment that ends when the words of the blessing end.

[11] **Proverbs 3:6**: ‘Know Him in all your ways, and He will make your paths straight.’

[12] **Mishneh Torah, Human Dispositions 3:3**: “Someone who conducts himself according to medicine, but intends only that his body and limbs should be sound and that he should have children to perform his work and labor for his needs, is not following a good path. Rather, he should intend that his body be sound and strong so that his soul may be upright in knowing Hashem, for one cannot understand and contemplate wisdom while hungry or ill, or while one of his limbs is in pain. He should intend to have a son who may become wise and great in Israel. Thus, one who follows this path

.מַיְמוֹן] — **as it is written: "In all your ways acknowledge Him" (Proverbs 3:6), as Maimonides explained.** וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי הַבְּרָכָה, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ: הַשּׁוֹעֵר בָּהּ קָטָן שֶׁיּוֹדֵעַ לְמִי מְבָרְכִין.[13] — **And this consciousness is achieved through the blessing; as the Sages stated regarding the qualifying age for a minor: a child who knows to Whom we recite blessings (Berakhot 48a).** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בִּשְׁאָר מִצְוֹת, אֵין הַשִּׁעוּר שֶׁיֵּדַע לְמִי מַנִּיחִין תְּפִלִּין וְכַיּוֹצֵא.[14] — **This is unlike other commandments, where the age definition is not framed around whether he knows to Whom one dons phylacteries (tefillin) or the like.** מִבֹּאָר שֶׁהַבְּרָכָה עִקָּרָהּ הַיְדִיעָה לְמִי מְבָרְכִין, שֶׁעַל כָּךְ נוֹסְדָה. — **Thus it is evident that the core essence of a blessing is the awareness of Whom one addresses, for that was its foundational purpose.** וְזֶהוּ הַתְחָלַת הַכְּנִיסָה לַתּוֹרָה, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה יִרְאַת הַשֵּׁם".[15] — **And this constitutes the primary gateway into the Torah, as it is written: "The beginning of wisdom is the fear of God" (Psalms 111:10).** וְיִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם הוּא עַל יְדֵי "שִׁוִּיתִי הַשֵּׁם לְנֶגְדִּי תָּמִיד",[16] כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בַּהֲגָהָה דְּרֵישׁ אֹרַח חַיִּים.[17] — **And the fear of Heaven is attained through "I have set the Lord before me always" (Psalms 16:8), as written in the gloss of the Rema at the beginning of Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim.** וְהַיְנוּ בְּרָכוֹת שֶׁבְּלָן מַתְחִילִין בִּלְשׁוֹן נוֹכֵחַ,[18] — **This also explains why all liturgical blessings open in the second-person direct address "Blessed are You...":** שֶׁמִּיָּד בְּהַתְחָלַת הַבְּרָכָה צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ נוֹכַח עֵינָיו כְּאִלּוּ עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וּמְצַוֶּהוּ. — **for at the very start of the blessing, the Blessed Name must be directly present before one's**

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throughout his life serves Hashem continually, even while doing business and even during marital relations, because his intention in everything is to obtain what he needs so that his body will be sound for serving Hashem. Even while sleeping, if he sleeps deliberately so that his mind and body may rest, lest he become ill and be unable to serve Hashem because of his illness, his sleep is service of the Omnipresent, blessed be He. Concerning this, the Sages commanded, 'Let all your deeds be for the sake of Heaven.' This is what Solomon said in his wisdom: 'Know Him in all your ways, and He will make your paths straight.'"

[13] **Berakhot 48a**: 'The halakhah does not follow any of these teachings, but rather this statement of Rav Nachman: A minor who knows to Whom the blessing is addressed may be included in the zimmun. Abaye and Rava were sitting before Rabbah. Rabbah asked them: 'To Whom do we recite the blessing?' They answered: 'To the Merciful One.' 'And where does the Merciful One dwell?' Rava pointed toward the ceiling. Abaye went outside and pointed toward heaven. Rabbah told them: 'Both of you will become Torah scholars.' This is what people say: 'Gourds are recognizable from their sap, as they first begin to form.''

[14] **Sukkah 42a:10**: "A minor who knows how to wave the lulav: The Sages taught, a minor who knows how to wave is obligated in lulav; one who knows how to wrap himself is obligated in tzitzit; one who knows how to safeguard tefillin—his father obtains tefillin for him; one who knows how to speak—his father teaches him Torah and the recitation of Shema."

Context: These age criteria concern the child's capacity to perform or safeguard each mitzvah. They supply the contrast to the criterion cited just before this phrase: knowing to Whom a blessing is addressed.

[15] **Psalms 111:10**: 'Fear of Hashem is the beginning of wisdom; all who carry out His commands have sound understanding. His praise endures forever.'

[16] **Psalms 16:8**: 'I have kept Hashem before me always; with Him at my right hand, I will not falter.'

[17] **Rema on Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 1:1**: ""I have set Hashem before me always" is a great principle of the Torah and of the virtues of the righteous who walk before God. A person's sitting, movements, and affairs when alone at home are unlike his sitting, movements, and affairs before a great king. His speech and free expression as he wishes among his household and relatives are unlike his speech in the king's presence. All the more so, when a person takes to heart that the great King, the Holy One, blessed be He, whose glory fills all the earth, stands over him and sees his deeds —as it is said, "Can a person hide in secret places and I not see him? declares Hashem"—fear and submission in awe of Hashem, and shame before Him, will immediately come upon him continually."

Context: This is the Rema's passage that Rav Tzadok explicitly cites. Awareness of standing before Hashem produces the awe that precedes action; it explains why the beginning of a blessing addresses Him directly as "You."

[18] **Recognition at the opening of a blessing**

The movement from direct address to concealment differs from an awareness permanently acquired in the heart.

Kisvei Rav Tzadok · Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Dover Tzedek, Berakhot 2:5: "Therefore, in this world, 'I am not read as I am written' (Pesachim 50a): every blessing begins in direct address, 'Blessed are You,' and then becomes concealed, 'Who has sanctified us.' Only at the beginning do 'his eyes look directly ahead,' as written in Tanya, chapter 41, that an intention for its own sake suffices at the beginning. [Therefore, a blessing adjoining another blessing needs only the first opening (Berakhot 46a). Some blessings conclude with 'Blessed,' corresponding to 'its beginning is words of Torah and its end is words of Torah,' explained above in another connection; this is not the place to elaborate.]"

Explanation: Dover Tzedek explains the same change of grammatical person through the difference between an opening recognition and an enduring possession of the heart. Its preceding discussion describes that enduring possession as the completion of the stages of service. This gives the siman's moment of direct address a precise role: it begins and directs the act, even while the awareness is not yet continuously manifest. It also connects this to the initial intention discussed in Siman 5.

eyes, as though He is standing over him and issuing the command. וְהַסִּיּוּם לְשׁוֹן נְסָתָר, דְּמִיָּד נָעְלָם, **— Yet the conclusion transitions into the third person "...Who has sanctified us", because He immediately recedes into transcendence,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "עַל גּוֹזָלָיו יְרַחֵף. נוֹגֵעַ וְאֵינוֹ נוֹגֵעַ, כַּיָּדוּעַ.[19] **— as it is written: "Over its fledglings He hovers" (Deuteronomy 32:11) — touching yet not touching, as is well known [Rashi on Deuteronomy 32:11].**

Siman 3

The Yoke of Heaven by Day and Night

עִקַּר הַקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע: קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם וְעוֹל תּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת כִּדְאִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת יג.),[20] [ג] , **— The core purpose of the recitation of Shema is the acceptance of the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven and the yoke of Torah and commandments, as taught in the Talmud (Berakhot 13a),** וְצָרִיךְ בַּיּוֹם וְלַיְלָה. **— and this obligation applies both by day and by night.** עַיֵּן שָׁם י"א עַמּוּד א'. וְלֹא בְּבֹקֶר וָעֶרֶב, אֶלָּא "בְּשָׁכְבְּךָ וּבְקוּמֶךָ".[21] **— Notice that the Torah did not formulate the obligation as "in the morning and evening," but rather "when you lie down and when you rise up" (cf. Berakhot 11a).** דְּיָהֵיב הַזְּמַן בָּזֶה מִשּׁוּם דְּהַבֹּקֶר וָעֶרֶב הֵם שִׁנּוּיִים בָּעוֹלָם וְלֹא בָּאָדָם, **— The Torah framed the requirement in terms of human posture because morning and evening represent astronomical changes in the cosmos, not internal shifts within man;** וְהָיָה דַּי בְּקַבָּלָה אַחַת לִשְׁנֵיהֶם. **— and were that the sole factor, a single daily acceptance of the yoke would have sufficed for both periods.** רַק מִפְּנֵי הַשִּׁנּוּיִים שֶׁבָּאָדָם, **— Rather, it is instituted because of the practical changes taking place within the human being:** שֶׁבַּיּוֹם קָם וְעוֹסֵק בְּמַלַאכְתּוֹ, וְצָרִיךְ קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם שֶׁכָּל מַעֲשָׂיו יִהְיוּ לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם, **— for during the daytime a person rises and engages in worldly work, needing the acceptance of Heaven's yoke so that all worldly labors are directed toward the service of Heaven,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֵירוּבִין סה.): "אֲנַן[22] כְּפוֹעֲלִים הָעוֹשִׂים מְלָאכָה שֶׁכָּל מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם לָאֲדוֹן, פּוֹעֲלֵי דִּימָמָא", **— as the Sages remarked (Eruvin 65a): "We are day-laborers," comparable to hired workers whose every effort belongs exclusively to their master,** וַאֲפִלּוּ בִּבְרָכַת הַמָּזוֹן מְקַצֵּר בִּשְׁבִיל עֲבוֹדָתוֹ (בְּרָכוֹת טז.).[23] **— such that a laborer even curtails the wording of Grace After Meals to return promptly to his employer's task (Berakhot 16a).** וּבַלַּיְלָה, עֵת שְׁכִיבָה וּמְנוּחָה, צָרִיךְ גַּם כֵּן קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם, [24] **— At night, however, which is an interval of reclining and passivity,**

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[19] **Deuteronomy 32:11**: "Like an eagle that stirs up its nest and hovers over its young, spreading its wings to take up a fledgling and carry it upon its pinion."

Rashi on Deuteronomy 32:11:3: "'Over its fledglings it hovers': it does not press its weight upon them, but hovers over them—touching and not touching."

[20] **Berakhot 13a:21**: "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Korcha said: Why does the paragraph "Shema" precede "And it shall be, if you listen"? So that one first accepts the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven, and afterward accepts the yoke of the commandments."

Context: This Mishnah supplies the two acceptances that Rav Tzadok identifies as the substance of Shema.

[21] **Berakhot 11a:2**: "Beit Shammai say: If so, let Scripture say "in the morning and in the evening." Why does it say "when you lie down and when you rise"?"

Berakhot 10b:39: "Why, then, does it say "when you lie down and when you rise"? At the time when people lie down, and at the time when people rise."

Context: The first quotation raises the wording question in Beit Shammai's argument; the second gives Beit Hillel's explanation of the times. Rav Tzadok draws attention to the Torah's choice of human activity, lying down and rising, to define the obligation.

[22] **Eruvin 65a**: 'Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: We are daytime workers. Rav Acha bar Yaakov would borrow [from his daytime study allotment] and repay [at night].'

[23] **Berakhot 16a:18–19**: "But it was taught: Laborers working for an employer recite Shema and pray. They eat their bread and do not recite a blessing before it, but afterward they recite two blessings. How so? They recite the first blessing in its usual form; in the second they begin with the blessing for the land and include "Who builds Jerusalem" within the blessing for the land. When does this apply? When they work for wages. But if they work in exchange for their meal, or if the employer reclines at the meal with them, they recite the blessings in their usual form."

Context: This is the Talmudic rule behind Rav Tzadok's illustration of a laborer's commitment to his employer's work. Its concluding qualifications are part of the source. Rav Tzadok uses that commitment as a model for dedicating the day's activity to Hashem.

[24] **Accepting Heaven's yoke at night preserves connection when it cannot be clearly seen**

Sod Yesharim distinguishes the morning's manifest recognition from the faith that sustains a person through apparent separation.

there is likewise a need to accept the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven: שֶׁגַּם בְּשָׁכְבוֹ עַל מִטָּתוֹ יֵדַע לִפְנֵי מִי הוּא שׁוֹכֵב, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בַּהַגָּהָה דְּרֵישׁ אֹרַח חַיִּים.[25] **— so that even resting upon his bed, he remains cognizant of before Whom he is lying down, as noted in the gloss at the beginning of Orach Chayim.** וְזֶה מְלַאכְתָּהּ יוֹתֵר וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁמַעְתִּי בָּזֶה, שֶׁמַּהֲחֲלוֹמוֹת נִכָּר מַעֲלַת הָאָדָם,[26] עַל פָּסוּק "וַיַּחֲלֹם יַעֲקֹב", אִם גַּם כְּשֶׁאֵינוֹ עוֹשֶׂה כְּלוּם, רַעְיוֹנָיו רַק "וְהִנֵּה הַשֵּׁם נִצָּב עָלָיו".[27] **— This aligns with what I heard expounded on the verse "And Jacob dreamed" (Genesis 28:12): that a person's true stature is revealed through dreams, — demonstrating whether even when inactive and unconscious, his thoughts remain fixated on "and behold, the Lord stood above him" (Genesis 28:13).** וּבְדָבָר זֶה, צַדִּיקִים מְעַטִּים שֶׁנִּתְפָּאֲרוּ כֵּן. **— And in this exceptional level of devotion, only rare righteous individuals could boast such achievement.** וּלְכָךְ נָתְנוּ בְּרָכָה הַיְתֵרָה לְעַרְבִית, שֶׁהוּא "הַשְׁכִּיבֵנוּ לְשָׁלוֹם".[28] **— For this reason the Sages established an additional protective blessing specifically for the evening prayer: Hashkiveinu ("Lay us down in peace").**

Siman 4

The Primacy of the Evening Acceptance

[ד] מִצְוָה רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁנִּתְחַיֵּב הָאָדָם כְּשֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בֶּן שְׁלֹשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה הוּא קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע שֶׁל עַרְבִית, שֶׁהוּא הָרִאשִׁית כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי לְעֵיל, כִּי הוּא וּבִרְכוֹת אֶחָד, רַק שֶׁהַבְּרָכוֹת בִּפְרָט הַמַּעֲשִׂים, וְזוֹ בְּכָלָל עַל כָּל מַעֲשֶׂה הַקִּימָה וְעַל כָּל מַעֲשֶׂה הַשְׁכִּיבָה. **— The very first commandment a young man becomes obligated in upon reaching thirteen years of age [the threshold of Bar Mitzvah, at nightfall] is the recitation of the evening Shema, which serves as the foundational beginning, as mentioned above. — For it [Shema] and blessings are one and the same, — except that blessings pertain to specific, individualized actions, whereas Shema is a comprehensive acceptance governing the entire act of rising and the entire act of lying down.** וְשָׁל עַרְבִית קוֹדֶם, כִּדְתָפַח בֵּיהּ תַּנָּא: "דְּקָרָא

Kisvei Ishbitz–Radzin · Sod Yesharim, Shabbat Chol HaMoed Sukkot 11:2: ""To declare Your kindness in the morning." When Abraham's morning shines before a person—as in "one called to another," translated "they receive from one another"—one explicitly recognizes "the kindness of God all day." "Your faithfulness in the nights" means that when Abraham's morning is concealed, a person does not recognize the connection. This concealment is called night: "One did not approach the other all night." As the Midrash explains, when people become separated from one another it is called night, appearing as separation and interruption. Then the person's only counsel is to hold to greater faith. This is "Your faithfulness in the nights." Through faith, the whole of a person's existence can be strengthened. In truth, a person's essential existence corresponds to the faith established in his heart. As the Zohar says, "'Her husband is known in the gates'—this is the Holy One, blessed be He, who becomes known according to what each measures within his heart, as much as each can cleave …." According to the faith that each establishes in his heart, God dwells within him and gives him existence and endurance."

Explanation: The Radziner passage explains the inward meaning of night: the connection is not apparent, so faith must carry the person's existence and endurance. This clarifies why the present siman requires a separate acceptance for lying down and calls that inactive service a greater labor. The night's avodah is not simply a second performance of the daytime task. It carries allegiance to Hashem into a condition in which ordinary conscious activity and visible reassurance have receded.

[25] **Rema on Shulchan Arukh, Orach Chayim 1:1**: "Even when going about privately and when lying upon his bed, he should know before Whom he lies. Immediately upon awakening from sleep, he should rise promptly to serve his Creator, blessed and exalted be He."

Context: Rav Tzadok quotes this clause almost word for word. It extends awareness of Hashem into the person's private, inactive state, and then carries that awareness into the moment of rising.

[26] **Genesis 28:12**: 'He dreamed, and there was a ladder standing on the earth, its top reaching toward heaven; and there were angels of God ascending and descending upon it.'

[27] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Genesis, Vayetzei 6**: ""The land upon which you lie, I shall give to you." The meaning of this blessing is that even while lying down and sleeping, your thoughts will be clear and pure."

Context: This teaching explains the same blessing of Yaakov in terms of the purity of his thoughts during sleep. It supplies the precise parallel to the teaching Rav Tzadok introduces with "I heard," at the phrase describing Yaakov's thoughts even when he is inactive.

[28] **Mishnah Berakhot 1:4**: "In the morning one recites two blessings before it [Shema] and one after it; in the evening, two before it and two after it."

Jerusalem Talmud Berakhot 1:5:2: "Rabbi Simon said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: [The blessings were set] because of "You shall meditate in it day and night" (Joshua 1:8), so that the meditation of the day and of the night should be equal. Rabbi Yosei son of Rabbi Avin said in the name of Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: Because of "Seven times a day I praise You for Your righteous judgments" (Psalms 119:164)."

Context: Hashkiveinu is the second blessing after the evening Shema, the one the evening has beyond the morning. Rashi on the Mishnah (Berakhot 11a) cites this Yerushalmi for the count of seven blessings.

קְאֵי"[29] — **And the evening Shema comes first chronologically, as the Mishna opens with the evening time: "The Tanna relies on the Scriptural verse,"** וְיָלִיף מִבְּרִיָּתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם לְעִנְיַן קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם: — **deriving the principle from the cosmic order of Creation regarding the acceptance of the yoke of Heaven:** דִּבְרֵי יֵשׁ חֲשׁוֹכָא[30,31,32] — **namely, that darkness precedes light ("first there was darkness, and then there was light").** צָרִיךְ קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם אַף מִתּוֹךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ וְהַסַּכָּלוּת וְהָעֲדֵר הַמַּעֲשִׂים, — **A person must accept the yoke of Heaven's sovereignty even from within obscurity, ignorance, and the absence of spiritual deeds;** וְאָז סוֹפוֹ לְקַיְּמָהּ בְּעֹשֶׁר וּנְהוֹרָא דִּימָמָא,[33] — **and subsequently, one will merit to fulfill it amid spiritual abundance and daytime illumination—** הַשָּׂגָה הַבְּרוּרָה שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִמְשָׁךְ הַמַּעֲשֶׂה. — **achieving that clear, luminous perception of the Divine through which active, tangible deeds are drawn forth into reality.**

Siman 5

The Sustained Continuity of the Yoke

וְאַף עַל פִּי שֶׁעִקַּר חִיּוּב קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם בִּקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע [ה], — **Although the primary obligation to accept the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven occurs during the recitation of Shema,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם חִיּוּבָהּ נִמְשָׁךְ לְעוֹלָם,

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[29] **Berakhot 2a**: 'The tanna bases his teaching on the verse that says, 'When you lie down and when you rise.' This is what he teaches: When is the time for the Shema recited on lying down? From the time the priests enter to eat their terumah.'

[30] **Shabbat 77b:8**: "He [Rabbi Zeira] said to him: Why do the goats go at the head [of the flock] and then the sheep? He [Rav Yehudah] said to him: Like the creation of the world—first darkness and then light."

[31] **Dover Tzedek, Kuntres Dover Tzedek, Berakhot 3:1-2**: "Berakhot (2a): "He derives it from the creation of the world," etc., see there. For with sacred offerings the night follows the day … even though at the creation of the world first there was darkness and then light (Shabbat 77b). … One might have thought that our acceptance of the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven depends on us, so that the day would come first. Therefore he said "and he derives it," etc.: as soon as a person has accepted the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven, and it has become clear to him that Hashem is One, everything returns to its source."

[32] **Fidelity before understanding seeks a greater light rather than permanent obscurity**

Sod Yesharim distinguishes Israel's readiness to follow beyond its grasp from a desire to remain in darkness without avodah.

Kisvei Ishbitz–Radzin · Sod Yesharim, The First Day of Pesach 15:2: "Israel had to clarify the difference so that it could be seen explicitly: between Israel's flock, a flock for a commandment, and Egypt's flock, a flock of idolatry. A flock hints at the evening before the morning, as the Gemara asks: "Why do goats walk first and then sheep? Like the world's creation: first darkness and then light, as it says, 'There was evening and there was morning.'" My holy father explained that this is what the Sages meant in saying that Egypt's idolatry was the flock. All their service was directed to the darkness preceding the light; they made that primordial darkness their object of fear, so that all their deeds would remain in darkness and they could receive every flow of good without any service, above their understanding. This is called darkness: proceeding without knowledge. Light is when a person proceeds with knowledge and reckoning. The Zohar says concerning this, "Flock was bound to flock": outwardly, Israel too follow without knowledge or calculation, above their apprehension. They were even called "a hasty people, who put your mouth before your ears," not calculating whether they would have the strength to bear it. Of this it says that Israel were bound in this for four hundred years, until the distinction would be explicitly clarified and separated from its knot. It would become apparent that Israel's entire purpose in following beyond their apprehension was to reach the source at the root of His will, which is a light far higher than the light called light from the human side. Such following without knowledge and reckoning is called a flock of a commandment. Egypt's flock, by contrast, is called idolatry: they do not wish to look at the light. They say that His will intentionally emanated evening before morning in order to conceal the light from human eyes, so that a person would always walk in darkness and not in light, with deeds in darkness. The Zohar speaks of the clarification's not being easily untied because this is truly a very fine distinction; it is not easy to show the difference between flock and flock explicitly to human eyes."

Explanation: Both passages invoke darkness preceding light, but Sod Yesharim explains why the direction of the response matters. Israel follows beyond present comprehension in order to reach the source of Hashem's will; Egypt treats the preceding darkness as a place in which to avoid accountable service. This sharpens the present siman's first acceptance of Heaven's yoke: one begins faithfully without clarity so that clearer understanding and deed can follow, rather than making lack of understanding an end in itself.

[33] **Pirkei Avot 4:9**: "Rabbi Yonatan says: Whoever upholds the Torah in poverty will ultimately uphold it in wealth; and whoever neglects the Torah in wealth will ultimately neglect it in poverty."

Context: Rav Tzadok draws on the Mishnah's "ultimately uphold it in wealth," applying poverty and wealth here to obscurity and clear understanding. The Mishnah's opposite clause is retained with the teaching.

nevertheless, its obligation continues at all times, שֶׁאֲפִלּוּ רֶגַע אֶחָד לֹא יָזוּז מִמֶּנּוּ הָעוֹל.[34] **— such that not even for a single moment should this yoke depart from him.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים: "עַל חֵטְא שֶׁחָטָאנוּ לְפָנֶיךָ בִּפְרִיקַת עוֹל", **— And this is like what we say in the confessional prayer: "For the sin we committed before You by casting off the yoke,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הַבַּעַל שֵׁם טוֹב עַל פָּסוּק: "אַשְׁרֵי אָדָם לֹא יַחְשֹׁב ה' לוֹ עָוֹן".[35] [36] **— and as the Baal Shem Tov explained on the verse: "Praiseworthy is the person to whom the Lord imputes no iniquity" (Psalms 32:2).** וְקַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם שֶׁל עַרְבִית זְמַנָּהּ כָּל זְמַן הַשְׁכִּיבָה, **— Now, the acceptance of the yoke of Heaven in the evening applies to the entire duration of lying down,** שֶׁכָּל הַלַּיְלָה צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת נוֹשֵׂא בְּעוֹל. **— meaning that throughout the entire night one must carry this yoke.** אֲבָל שֶׁל שַׁחֲרִית רַק בִּתְחִלַּת הַקִּיּוּמָה, **— In the morning, however, the direct obligation applies only at the initial moment of rising,** וּכְמוֹ הַבְּרָכָה בִּתְחִלַּת הַמִּצְוָה סַגִּי עַל כָּל הַמִּצְוָה, אַף שֶׁנִּמְשֶׁכֶת זְמַן מַה. **— just as the blessing recited at the start of a commandment suffices for the entire duration of the mitzvah, even if it continues for a while.** לְפִי שֶׁקַּבָּלַת הָעוֹל דַּי בִּתְחִלַּת הַמַּעֲשֶׂה, וְאַחַר כָּךְ קְדֻשַּׁת הַמַּעֲשֶׂה מַמְשֶׁכֶת. **— For accepting the yoke at the very beginning of the deed is sufficient, and thereafter the sanctity of the act carries itself forward.** וּכְמוֹ "בִּלְשָׁמָהּ" גִּטִּין, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בְּתַנָּיָא פֶּרֶק מ"א,[37] **— This parallels the requirement of intent "for her sake" in writing a bill of divorce, as explained in Tanya, Chapter 41;** הָכָא נַמִּי בְּיוֹם, שֶׁהוּא עֵת הַמַּעֲשֶׂה, הוּא רַק בִּתְחִלַּת הַמַּעֲשֶׂה. **— so too regarding the day, which is the time of active deed, the explicit acceptance is needed only at the inception of action.** וּכְדַיְיקָ קְרָא "בְּשָׁכְבְּךָ" – הַיְנוּ כָּל הַלַּיְלָה דְּשׁוֹכְבִין. **— And this is precise in the wording of the verse: "when you lie down" (b'shokhbekha) denotes the entire night during which one remains lying.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן "וּבְקוּמֶךָ" הוּא רַק בִּתְחִלַּת יוֹם, דְּאָז קָמִין וְעוֹמְדִין, **— In contrast, "when you rise" (u'vekumekha) refers only to the start of the day, when people arise and stand up,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּל הַיּוֹם הוֹלֵךְ וְיוֹשֵׁב, וְלֹא שַׁיָּךְ "בְּקוּמֶךָ". **— whereas for the rest of the day one walks and sits, so the term "when you rise" would no longer**

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[34] **Sefer HaZikhronot 1:27–29**: "I found in Pesikta Zutarta, Parashat Ekev, concerning "Beware lest you forget": this is one who casts off the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven, eating without prayer and without a blessing. It appears that forgetting is interpreted as casting off the yoke. Although blessings over enjoyment and the prohibition against eating before prayer are only rabbinic prohibitions, since Israel have already become accustomed to them, one who violates them does so through casting off the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven. Casting off the yoke is the subject of the warning against forgetting. Accordingly, this is a continual warning that there should be no moment in which he casts off the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven. This requires great mindfulness, so that the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven remains continually upon his heart, in addition to accepting the yoke in Shema morning and evening.

Sefer Yereim, section 11, explains this warning as requiring a person not to forget to accept the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven and recite Shema each day. According to the view that Shema is rabbinic, he explains that a person should continually remember his Creator and His commandments. His position is that accepting the yoke morning and evening suffices. Presumably the concluding word "continually" has the same meaning: he should remember this matter every day in the morning and evening, or at another time during the day and night. Someone who recites Shema and prays without any attention, because his heart is directed elsewhere, and who throughout the entire day never brings the remembrance of Hashem to his heart, has violated this warning according to his words.

Rabbeinu Yonah writes in Sha'arei Teshuvah, gate 3, section 27, that this is a warning to remember Hashem at all times, and the apparent meaning of his words is literally at every moment. Yet it seems that this interpretation would not be pleasing to the Master: one who forgot for a single moment would transgress a prohibition, and a person would thereby transgress countless prohibitions every day. As explained, not every person merits remaining constantly attached to Hashem, never departing entirely from remembrance of Him even while occupied with worldly affairs and the like."
Context: Rav Tzadok distinguishes an enduring acceptance of Hashem's authority from uninterrupted conscious contemplation. This discussion gives essential context to "not even for one moment should the yoke depart from him," before the following teaching describes the exceptional level of constant attachment.

[35] **Degel Machaneh Ephraim, Vayikra 16**: "I heard from my master, my grandfather, of blessed memory, concerning the verse 'Fortunate is the person to whom Hashem does not reckon iniquity': his thought is continually attached to the blessed Hashem. Therefore, when he falls away from that thought for a single moment and does not think of Hashem, he regards it as iniquity and sin. This is 'Fortunate is the person who does not think of Hashem': when he does not think of Hashem, 'it is iniquity for him'—it is an iniquity in his eyes. This is a sign that his thought is continually attached to the blessed Hashem, and therefore fortunate is he."

[36] **Psalms 32:2**: 'Fortunate is the person to whom Hashem does not reckon guilt, and in whose spirit there is no deceit.'

[37] **Tanya, Part I; Likkutei Amarim 41:25**: "With this preparation of surrendering his soul to Hashem, he should begin the morning blessings: 'Blessed are You…' With this same preparation, he should begin his regular study session immediately after prayer. Likewise, before beginning to study in the middle of the day, he needs at least this preparation. As is known, for people at the intermediate spiritual level, the indispensable preparation for studying for its own sake takes place at the beginning of the study. This is like a bill of divorce or a Torah scroll, for which the proper intention is indispensable: it is enough to declare at the beginning of writing, 'I am writing for the sake of the sanctity of a Torah scroll,' or 'for his sake and for hers,' and so on."

apply. וְהֵינוּ דְּעַל יוֹם מַעֲשֶׂה, כְּלָלוּת הַקַּבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם בִּתְחִלַּת הַיּוֹם דַּי. — **This demonstrates that for an active workday, the general acceptance of the yoke of Heaven made at the outset of the day is entirely sufficient.**

Siman 6

The Sequential Stages of Accepting the Kingdom

[ו] קַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם שְׁלֵמָה אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת טו.):[38] — **Regarding the complete acceptance of the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven, the Sages stated (Berakhot 15a):** "נִפְנָה" – פֵּרוּשׁ: מִכָּל גִּלּוּלֵי תַּאֲווֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה הַמֻּתָּרוֹת אֲשֶׁר לֹא לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם.[39] — **"He relieves himself" — meaning an inward cleansing from all the base, worldly desires, even permissible ones, that are not pursued for the sake of Heaven.** "וְנִטַל יָדָיו" – שֶׁמַּעְתִּי שֶׁזֶּה רְמִיזַת רְחִיצַת יָדַיִם עַל סִלּוּק נְגִיעוֹת.[40] — **"And washes his hands" — I have heard [from the Izbitzer Rebbe] that this washing of hands is an allusion to divesting oneself of personal biases and selfish motives.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר עוֹד: רוֹמֵז עַל הָרְחִיצָה מִמַּה שֶּׁכָּבָר נִתְלַכְלְכוּ כְּלֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה מֵאוֹתָם הַטִּנּוּפוֹת, יִרְחֲצֵם בְּמֵי הַדַּעַת וְטָהֵר.[41] — **And one could further suggest: it hints at washing clean the instruments of action that were soiled by those base contaminations, cleansing them in the purifying waters of divine understanding so that one becomes**

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[38] **Berakhot 15a**: 'Rabbi Yochanan also said: Someone who wishes to accept upon himself the complete yoke of Heaven's kingship should relieve himself, wash his hands, put on tefillin, recite the Shema, and pray. This is the complete acceptance of Heaven's kingship. Rabbi Chiyya bar Abba said in the name of Rabbi Yochanan: Anyone who relieves himself, washes his hands, puts on tefillin, recites the Shema, and prays is regarded by Scripture as though he built an altar and offered a sacrifice upon it, as it is written: 'I wash my hands in purity and circle Your altar, Hashem.' Rava said to him: Does the Master not hold that it is as though he immersed? For it says erchatz, 'I will bathe [in purity],' and does not say architz, 'I will wash [my hands].''

[39] **Tzidkat HaTzadik 220:1**: "This is the meaning of "tefillin require a clean body": one should be completely clean of every desire for the affairs of this world. Bodily cleanliness in its plain sense also removes distracting thoughts. As the Jerusalem Talmud, Berakhot, chapter 3, halakhah 5, says, one keeps a distance from a child's excrement because his thoughts are bad. The essential reason that removing excrement is called "your camp shall be holy" is the distracting and evil thoughts arising from it, for holiness is their opposite. Therefore the Sages said, "He should relieve himself and wash his hands," and so forth: this is the complete acceptance of the yoke of Heaven. Even "he should relieve himself" is included in accepting that yoke. This is why the practice has become weak in our hands: it is difficult to attain this level, and none arose like Moses. At least during prayer a person should strive to attain it—to cleave entirely to Hashem with all his heart, soul, and resources. It is sufficient to wear tefillin then; throughout the rest of the day he should be satisfied with wrapping himself in tzitzit, so that he will at least remember to repel every distracting thought that confronts him." **Context:** Rav Tzadok returns to the same Talmudic sequence and explicitly includes bodily preparation within accepting Heaven's yoke. The closing practical qualification distinguishes the ideal of constant purity from the concentration sought during prayer.

[40] **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Exodus, Ki Tisa 1**: "'They shall wash their hands and feet.' The priests' washing from the laver signifies the removal and elimination of personal bias. Washing indicates this, as it is written concerning the heifer whose neck is broken: 'The elders shall wash,' and so forth, 'and say: Our hands did not shed,' and so forth. They declare that they have no personal involvement or share in this deed. The priest who serves also needs washing: he must remove his personal bias and nullify his judgment and will before the will of the blessed Hashem, serving only in the way that Hashem desires. So too, our command to wash our hands in the morning and before a meal means that before beginning to attend to bodily needs, a person needs to pray to Hashem. If something of this world comes to him that is, Heaven forbid, contrary to Hashem's will, he asks Hashem to take away and remove his desire for it. Even a permitted thing contains good and its opposite. If a person eats something permitted and afterward uses that strength to commit a transgression, it becomes apparent that he did not receive the good power contained in that thing. This is the purpose of washing: a prayer to Hashem that, in everything, he receive only the good power it contains. For a person may stipulate concerning an inheritance coming to him from elsewhere that he will not inherit it. For this reason, they established the recitation of the passage of the laver before prayer and before the passages of the offerings: that we should pray only for what Hashem desires."

[41] **Mishneh Torah, Immersion Pools 11:12**: "It is clear and evident that the laws of impurity and purity are decrees of Scripture. They are not matters decided by human reason; they belong among the statutes. Immersion from impurity likewise belongs among the statutes, for impurity is not mud or filth that water can remove. It is a decree of Scripture, and the matter depends on the heart's intention. Therefore the Sages said: if one immersed without establishing the intended degree of purification, it is as though he had not immersed. Nevertheless, there is an allusion in this matter. Just as one who intends in his heart to purify himself becomes pure upon immersion, although nothing has changed in his body, so one who intends to purify his soul from the impurities of the soul—wicked thoughts and evil opinions—becomes pure once he resolves in his heart to separate from those counsels and brings his soul into the waters of knowledge. Scripture says: 'I shall sprinkle pure water upon you, and you shall become pure; from all your impurities and all your idols I shall purify you.' May Hashem, in His abundant mercy, purify us from every sin, iniquity, and guilt. Amen."

צְדָקַת הַצַּדִּיק

TZIDKAS HATZADDIK

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Volume II · Sections 171–264

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin

Akiva Publishing · 2026

Tzidkas HaTzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition · Volume II · Sections 171–264

This volume presents sections 171–264 of Tzidkas HaTzaddik in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in numbered footnotes.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

Original work צדקת הצדיק by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

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Published by Akiva Publishing · Two-volume interlinear edition, 2026

Siman 171

There Is a Place Prepared for Distress

בִּשְׁכֶם מָקוֹם וְכוּלֵי;[2209] [קעא] יֵשׁ מָקוֹם מוּכָן לְצַעַר חֵס וְשָׁלוֹם, כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּפֶרֶק חֵלֶק (סַנְהֶדְרִין קב.): — **There is a place prepared for distress, Heaven forbid, as our Sages stated in chapter Chelek (Sanhedrin 102a): in Shechem, a place prepared for calamity;** עַת וְכֵן זְמַן, כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שָׁם): בַּר יִשְׂרָאֵל דְּאִית לֵיהּ דִּינָא וְכוּלֵי בְּאָב וְכוּלֵי;[2210] וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית כט:): — **and likewise time, as our Sages said: a time prepared for calamity, and as stated (Ta'anit 29b): a Jew who has litigation with a gentile should avoid it in the month of Av;** וְכֵן בַּנֶּפֶשׁ, כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שָׁם כה.) בְּרַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן פְּדָת וְטוּבָא.[2211] — **and likewise in the soul, in the manner our Sages taught (ibid. 25a) regarding Rabbi Elazar ben Pedat, and many others.** וְאֵיךְ יְצוּיַר זֶה שֶׁמּוּכָן מִתְּחִלַּת בְּרִיאָה לְרַע חַס וְשָׁלוֹם, וַהֲלֹא "מִפִּי עֶלְיוֹן לֹא תֵצֵא הָרָעוֹת" (אֵיכָה ג, לח)?[2212] — **And how can it be conceived that something was prepared from the inception of Creation for evil, Heaven forbid, seeing that "out of the mouth of the Most High proceeds not evil" (Lamentations 3:38)?** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת לְשׁוֹן חֲכָמִים מַרְפֵּא, שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה "מוּכָן לְפֵרְעָנוּת" – לְשׁוֹן פֵּרָעוֹן; רַק פֵּירָעוֹן[2213] רַק דְּשָׂכַר מִצְוָה בְּהַאי עָלְמָא לֵיכָּא (קִדּוּשִׁין לט:), הָעֲבֵירוֹת, אִם לֹא שֶׁזָּכָה לִטְעוֹם מִפְּרִי מַעֲשָׂיו בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אוֹ מֵאוֹתָן מִצְוֹות שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם פֵּירוֹת.[2214] — **only that reward for a mitzvah does not exist in this world (Kiddushin 39b), but only payment for transgressions, unless one merits to taste the fruit of his deeds in this world or from those mitzvot that bear terrestrial fruit.** וְאוֹתוֹ הַזְּמַן, מָקוֹם וְנֶפֶשׁ הוּא מוּכָן לְקַבֵּל פֵּירָעוֹן מַה שֶּׁנִּשְׁתַּכֵּר. וּמַה דְּשָׂכַר מִצְוָה בְּהַאי עָלְמָא לֵיכָּא, הַיְינוּ מִשּׁוּם דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא נוֹתֵן מְלֹא עָמְסוֹ.[2215] וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה לְקַבֵּל רוֹב טוֹבָה הַהוּא כְּלָל. וְכוּלֵי (סַנְהֶדְרִין ק.), — **And that time, place, and soul are prepared to receive the recompense of what was earned.** **And the reason reward for a mitzvah**

2209 **Sanhedrin 102a**: ‘‘Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had come to Shechem to make him king.’ It was taught in the name of Rabbi Yosei: It is a place marked out for calamity. In Shechem Dinah was violated; in Shechem Joseph’s brothers sold him; in Shechem the kingdom of the house of David was divided.’

2210 **Sanhedrin 102a:4**: “It was taught in Rabbi Yosei’s name: It was a time prepared for calamity.”

Taanit 29b:1: “Rav Pappa said: Therefore, a Jew who has litigation with a gentile should avoid it in Av, when his fortune is unfavorable, and make himself available in Adar, when his fortune is favorable.”

Context: Sanhedrin supplies the general expression “a time prepared for calamity”; Taanit gives the particular comparison of Av and Adar. Rav Tzadok is asking how such a distinction in time can be reconciled with the goodness of creation.

2211 **Taanit 25a:11-13**: “Rabbi Elazar ben Pedat was in very straitened circumstances. He underwent bloodletting and had nothing to eat afterward. He took a clove of garlic and put it in his mouth; his heart grew faint and he fell asleep. The Sages came to inquire after him. They saw him weeping and laughing, and a flash of fire emerged from his forehead. When he awoke, they asked him, “Why were you weeping and laughing?” He told them: “The Holy One, blessed be He, was sitting with me, and I said to Him, ‘How long must I suffer in this world?’ He said to me, ‘Elazar, My son, would you like Me to overturn the world from its beginning? Perhaps you would then be born at a time of sustenance.’ I said before Him, ‘All that—and only perhaps?’ I asked Him, ‘Have I already lived longer than I have yet to live?’ He said to me, ‘You have already lived longer.’ I said before Him, ‘If so, I do not want it.’”””

Context: This is the specific story cited for hardship associated with a person’s original circumstances. The selected narrative retains both the uncertainty of a different birth and Rabbi Elazar’s eventual refusal; Rav Tzadok’s explanation of such hardship as an excess of divine bestowal is his interpretation.

2212 **Lamentations 3:38**: see note 1221 (Vol. I).

Context: The verse is often translated as a rhetorical question. Rav Tzadok quotes its negative wording as a statement about evil not proceeding from the divine source. The Midrash also reads the wording negatively, in its discussion of human action and its consequences; Rav Tzadok develops his own explanation of the goodness at creation’s root.

2213 **Kiddushin 39b**: ‘Abaye said: The Mishnah refers to preparing a good day or a bad day for a person [in the World to Come]. Rava said: Whose view is this? It is Rabbi Yaakov’s, for he said: There is no reward for a mitzvah in this world.’

2214 **Mishnah Peah 1:1**: “These are the things whose fruits a person eats in this world, while the principal remains for him in the World to Come: honoring father and mother, acts of kindness, and making peace between one person and another; and Torah study is equal to them all.”

Context: The Mishnah supplies the qualification concerning mitzvot that yield “fruits” in this world while their principal reward remains for the World to Come. It complements the existing source for the general statement about reward.

2215 **Sanhedrin 100a:15**: “Rav Dimi said: The Holy One, blessed be He, will give each righteous person His full handful, as it says, “Blessed is the Lord, day by day, who loads us with benefit.” Abaye asked him: Can one say so? Is it

does not exist in this world is because the Holy One gives according to His full capacity (Sanhedrin 100a), and it is impossible in this physical world to receive that immense goodness at all. וּבְאוֹתוֹ מָקוֹם, זְמַן, נֶפֶשׁ שֶׁנִּשְׁפַּע הַפְּירָעוֹן וּשְׂכָרוֹ שֶׁל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, מִצַּד רִבּוּי הַשֶּׁפַע נַעֲשֶׂה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם פְּרִעָנוּת לְרַע, כִּידוּעַ בְּסוֹד שְׁבִירָתָן[2216] **— And in that place, time, and soul wherein the recompense and reward of the Blessed Name are poured out, out of the sheer abundance of the influx it becomes, Heaven forbid, pur'anut for apparent evil, as is known in the esoteric secret of the Shattering of the Vessels, which was their demise through the overwhelming abundance of light;** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה עַל פָּסוּק "לֹא יִרְאַנִי" – הָא בְּשָׁעַת מִיתָתָן רוֹאֶה.[2217](פִּרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר פֶּרֶק לד) **— and so our Sages stated (Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 34) on "man shall not see Me and live"—behold, at the hour of their death they see.** וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (יוֹמָא נד:)[2218]; אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם, שֶׁמָּצְאוּ כְּרוּבִים מְעוֹרִים **— And therefore our Sages stated (Yoma 54b) that they found the cherubim intertwined in embrace, even though Israel was not performing the will of the Omnipresent;** כִּי אָז הָיָה תֹּקֶף רִבּוּי שֶׁפַע הָאוֹר, וּלְכָךְ זָכָה יְחֶזְקֵאל לְמַרְאוֹת אֱלֹהִים.[2219] **— for then was the peak of the overwhelming abundance of the light's influx, and therefore Ezekiel merited the visions of God.** וּמִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה בֶּאֱמֶת, מְקַבֵּל פֵּירָעוֹן הַטּוֹבָה אָז, שֶׁזֶּה עִנְיַן לֵידַת מָשִׁיחַ בְּטִשְׁעָה בְּאָב.[2220] **— And whoever truly merits receives the payment of goodness then, which is the inner meaning of the birth of the Messiah on the Ninth of Av.** לַכֹּל נָתַתָּ בֵּן זוּג, שֶׁלְּכָל וְאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה יא):[2221] שֶׁשַּׁ דָּבָר שֶׁהוּא מַמָּשׁ נָגְדּוֹ וְזֶהוּ לְעֵזֶר לוֹ.[2222]דָּבָר יֵשׁ זוּג, דְּהַיְינוּ עֵזֶר כְּנֶגְדּוֹ , **— And our Sages stated (Bereishit Rabbah**

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not written, "Who measured the waters in the hollow of His hand, and measured the heavens with a span"?"

Sanhedrin 100b:2: "Just as the Holy One, blessed be He, gives the wicked strength to receive their punishment, so He gives the righteous strength to receive their good."

Context: The question concerns the human capacity to receive a divine measure of good. The answer continues on 100b: God supplies the capacity to receive it. This explains Rav Tzadok's contrast between present bodily limits and future reward.

2216 **Sefer Etz Chaim, Shaar HaKlalim 2:2**: "When the supreme Emanator saw that these vessels had shattered because the light was great and they could not bear it, it arose in His will to repair all the worlds in such a way that they could bear this light. This takes place through the spreading out of the light and their distance from the supreme Emanator, so that the lights arrive more concealed. In this way the worlds will endure and have the strength to bear the light."

Context: Etz Chaim explicitly describes the vessels' shattering through their inability to bear the great light, followed by repair through a form of reception they can sustain. This supplies the kabbalistic model behind Rav Tzadok's language; its application to suffering in particular places, times, and souls is his own development.

2217 See notes 1497 and 1498 (Vol. I).

2218 **Yoma 54b**: 'Like a man joined to his companion. Reish Lakish said: When the nations entered the Sanctuary, they saw the cherubim embracing one another. They took them out to the marketplace and said: 'These Israelites, whose blessing is a blessing and whose curse is a curse—do they occupy themselves with such things?' Immediately they treated them with contempt, as it is said: 'All who honored her have despised her, for they have seen her nakedness.''

2219 **Peri Tzadik, Sukkot 18:1**: "For I heard from my holy master, teacher, and rabbi, of righteous and holy memory, that when they went into exile in Babylonia, everyone went with a bitter soul, while Ezekiel went with great joy. This was because Ezekiel sensed the light of holiness that the Holy One, blessed be He, would cause to shine upon Israel in Babylonia, more than when they dwelt upon their own land. So it was: there was revealed to Ezekiel what had not been revealed to any other prophet or seer, as it is taught in the holy Zohar, volume II, 2b: "When they went down to Babylonia, the heavens opened, and the holy spirit rested upon Ezekiel. He saw what he saw and said to Israel: Your Master is here, and all the hosts of Heaven and the chariot, which has come to dwell among you.… When Israel saw this, they rejoiced … and were not concerned about their exile at all, for they knew that the Holy One, blessed be He, had not abandoned them, and that the Shekhinah was there with them.""

2220 **Jerusalem Talmud Berakhot 2:4:12**: see note 613 (Vol. I).

Context: The Yerushalmi's aggadah joins the destruction of the Temple to the birth of the Messiah. The complete source unit includes the child's later disappearance and Rabbi Bun's scriptural conclusion; Rav Tzadok reads the juxtaposition as hidden good present within the time of destruction.

2221 **Bereshit Rabbah 11:8**: "Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai taught: Shabbat said before the Holy One, blessed be He: Master of the world, each has a partner, but I have no partner. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to her: The congregation of Israel is your partner. When Israel stood before Mount Sinai, He said to them: Remember what I said to Shabbat—that the congregation of Israel is your partner. This is "Remember the Sabbath day to sanctify it.""

Context: The source personifies Shabbat as seeking a partner and assigns Israel that role. Rav Tzadok uses that union in explaining the sanctity of time.

2222 **Genesis 2:18**: "Hashem God said: It is not good for the man to be alone; I will make him a helper corresponding to him (ezer kenegdo)."

11): unto all You gave a mate, for every entity has a counterpart, meaning a "helpmate opposite him," where something is literally opposite him and that serves as his help. וְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְלַאכְתּוֹ הוּא מִיּוֹם שֶׁנִּבְרָא — לְזַוֵּוג זִוּוּגִים אֵלּוּ שֶׁל מָקוֹם וּזְמַן וְנֶפֶשׁ כָּל אֶחָד בְּהֶפְקֵנוּ; הָעוֹלָם כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה סח):[2223] **And the work of the Blessed Name since the day the world was created (Bereishit Rabbah 68) is to pair these unions of place, time, and soul, each with its opposite;** דְּיֵשׁ מָקוֹם מוּכָן לְהַיִּפָּךְ מַמָּשׁ, שֶׁלֹּא לְקַבֵּל שׂוּם שְׂכַר מִצְוָה בְּהֶוֶה, וּבְזִוּוּגָם מִתְמַתְּקִים יַחַד.[2224] **— for there is a place prepared for the exact opposite, not to receive any immediate reward for deeds, but to trust in the Master of the house Who is faithful to pay reward, and in their union they are sweetened together.** וְיָדוּעַ נֶגֶד כ"ב יָמִים שֶׁבֵּין הַמְּצָרִים הֵם מֵרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה עַד שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת[2225] **— And it is known that facing the twenty-two days of Bein HaMetzarim (from 17 Tammuz to 9 Av) stand the twenty-two days from Rosh Hashanah through Shemini Atzeret** (תַּעֲנִית כט.), וְשִׂמְחַת תּוֹרָה הוּא נֶגֶד י' בְּאָב, דְּאָמַר רַבִּי יוֹחָנָן: אִלּוּ הֲוַאי הָתָם וְכוּלֵי[2226] **— [and Simchat Torah corresponds to the Tenth of Av, concerning which Rabbi Yochanan said: Had I been there, I would have established the fast on the Tenth (Ta'anit 29a),** כִּי סָפֵיקָא דְיוֹמָא שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם טוֹב הוּא נֶגֶד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **— for the rabbinic second day of the diaspora (safeka deyoma) on every festival corresponds to the Oral Torah resembling the Written Torah, which are the two Tablets of the Covenant,** הַדּוֹמֶה לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב שֶׁהֵם שְׁנֵי לוּחוֹת הַבְּרִית, וְכֵן שְׁנֵי יָמִים יוֹם טוֹב אֶחָד דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא וְאֶחָד דְּרַבָּנָן, וְהַקְּדוּשָּׁה יוֹרֶדֶת לִשְׁנֵי הַיָּמִים; **— and so two days of Yom Tov, one biblical and one rabbinic, where the holiness descends into both days;** וְכֵן הַשֶּׁפַע שֶׁיָּרַד לְט' בְּאָב שֶׁהָיָה מִלְמַעְלָה שֶׁפַע גָּדוֹל וְעָצוּם כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל, נִתְחַלֵּק גַּם לִי' בְּאָב, וּלְמַטָּה נִתְהַפֵּךְ רַחֲמָנָא לִצְלַן]. **— and so the influx that descended upon the Ninth of Av, which from Above was an immense influx as noted above, was divided unto the Tenth of Av as well, though below it was inverted into tragedy, may the Merciful One preserve us].** וְיָדוּעַ דְּטַעַם סֻכָּה הוּא הַחְסָיוֹן בַּה' וְהַבְטָחוֹן בּוֹ.[2227] **— And it is known that the reason for the**

[2223] **Bereshit Rabbah 68:4**: "A noblewoman asked Rabbi Yosei ben Chalafta: In how many days did the Holy One create His world? He said: In six days. She said: What has He been doing from that time until now? He said: The Holy One sits and makes matches—the daughter of so-and-so to so-and-so, the wife of so-and-so to so-and-so, the property of so-and-so to so-and-so."

Context: The Midrash uses matchmaking to describe the continuing arrangement of particular connections within creation. Rav Tzadok applies that pattern to the joining of sanctified persons and times.

[2224] **Pirkei Avot 2:14**: "Rabbi Elazar says: Be diligent in the study of Torah… Know before whom you toil; and your Employer is faithful to pay you the reward of your work."

[2225] **Chidushei Agadot on Bekhorot 8b:4**: "Further, "They brought two eggs and said to him: Which is from the hen"—this follows what was said in our passage: a hen produces after twenty-one days, and its counterpart among trees is the almond. We say that Yirmeyahu alluded to this in "I see an almond rod": the twenty-one days from the seventeenth of Tammuz to the Ninth of Av. They alluded to these days by a black hen, on account of exile. There are also twenty-one days of forgiveness and joy, from the first festival day of Rosh Hashanah to the twenty-first of Tishrei, Hoshana Rabbah, the day on which the sealing is completed, as found in the Midrashim. To these they alluded by a white hen, on account of the whitening of sins. Thus they said: The two eggs produced by the two hens are both white, and one cannot recognize which came from the black hen and which from the white. Likewise, you have no distinguishing sign, for one fate befalls them all: calamities and good things have equal numbers of days, twenty-one, and there is no ground for your hope. He answered by the corresponding example of black goats: these are the two goats Israel brought on Yom Kippur. The white one represents the goat for Hashem, and the black one the goat for Azazel. The cheese produced from both is white, for the goat sent to Azazel also whitened Israel's sins, as it says, "The goat shall bear"; and as they said, they tied a crimson thread to the scapegoat, and when it reached the wilderness it turned white. So too with the two hens: both produced after twenty-one days, and both produced white eggs. These two periods of twenty-one days likewise have equal results in whitening: just as the twenty-one days from Rosh Hashanah to Hoshana Rabbah produce the whitening and atonement of sins, so the twenty-one days of calamity from the seventeenth of Tammuz to the Ninth of Av produced the whitening of sins, for troubles and sufferings atone, as they said, "Exile atones.""

Context: Maharsha gives a related correspondence between the Three Weeks and the season of repentance and rejoicing, interpreting both as periods of cleansing. His count is twenty-one days ending at Hoshana Rabbah; Rav Tzadok here develops the correspondence through the inclusive twenty-two-day span ending at Shemini Atzeret.

[2226] **Taanit 29a:10**: "On the ninth, toward nightfall, they set fire to it, and it kept burning the whole day, as it is said: 'Woe to us, for the day has declined, for the shadows of evening are lengthening' (Jeremiah 6:4). And this is what Rabbi Yochanan said: Had I been in that generation, I would have fixed it only on the tenth, because most of the Sanctuary burned on that day. And the Rabbis held that the beginning of the calamity takes precedence."

Context: The fire began near the end of the ninth and burned through the tenth; this is why Rabbi Yochanan would have fixed the fast on the tenth of Av.

[2227] **Sefat Emet, Deuteronomy, Sukkot 13:5**: "The mitzvah of sukkah is the quality of trust in Hashem, blessed be He. As our Sages said, "Leave your permanent dwelling": do not trust in wealth and possessions, but trust in Hashem. Therefore it is the time of our rejoicing, for there is no joy like the joy of one who truly trusts in Hashem, as explained in

Sukkah is seeking refuge in Hashem and trusting in Him. וְנֶגֶד ט' בְּאָב הוּא שְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת, שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה מִמָּשׁ הֵיפֶךְ ט' בְּאָב.[2230] וְכוּלֵי, אֲנִי וְאַתֶּם, כְּמוֹ לֶעָתִיד "ה' בָּדָד יַנְחֶנּוּ וְגוֹמֵר",[2229] פַּר אֶחָד[2228](מִדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא פִּינְחָס טז): — **And facing the Ninth of Av is Shemini Atzeret, concerning which our Sages stated (Midrash Tanchuma, Pinchas 16): one bull—I and you alone, like the future 'Hashem alone shall lead him' (Deuteronomy 32:12), the exact opposite of the Ninth of Av.** וְכ"ב יָמִים הֵם נֶגֶד כ"ב אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁפָּגְמוּ, כְּמַאֲמַר רַבּוֹתֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּאֵיכָה רַבָּתִי,[2231] — **And the twenty-two days correspond to the twenty-two letters of the Torah which they blemished, as our Sages expounded in Eichah Rabbah,** וְנִשְׂרְפָה[2232] דִּלְכָךְ בְּי"ז בְּתַמּוּז נִשְׁתַּבְּרוּ לוּחוֹת הַתּוֹרָה, וְהוּא נֶגֶד אוֹת א' שֶׁמַּתְחִיל בּוֹ אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה, — **which is why on the Seventeenth of Tammuz the Tablets were broken and the Torah was burned, corresponding to the letter Aleph which begins the letters of the Torah,** וּבְאוֹתוֹ זְמַן יוֹרֵד שֶׁפַע דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה, רַק שֶׁהוּא בִּרְאִיָּה כְּטַעַם מַרְאוֹת יְחֻזְקֵאל.[2233] — **and during that period an abundant influx of words of Torah descends, only that it occurs in vision, matching the visions of Ezekiel.** הָרוֹאֶה יְחֶזְקֵאל יְצִפֶּה לְחָכְמָה, שֶׁזֶּהוּ דּוּגְמַת פֶּסַח "רָאֲתָה שִׁפְחָה וְאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרָכוֹת נז:)[2234] וְכוּלֵי",[2235] — **And our Sages stated (Berakhot 57b): one who sees Ezekiel should anticipate wisdom,**

Chovot HaLevavot. Therefore prayers and Hoshanot were instituted on this festival: to know that all the blessings of the year depend only on Hashem's help, and not to trust in gathering all the produce into one's house. As it is written, "Trust in Him at all times, O people; pour out your hearts before Him." The water libation alludes to this: pouring out the heart like water before Him, blessed be He. Surely this is implanted in the hearts of Israel: whenever they need deliverance, they trust in Him. Therefore Hashem shelters them during these days, as it is written, "One who trusts in Hashem—kindness will surround him.""

Context: Sefat Emet's Sukkot teaching for 5645 explains the sukkah as trust, including its practical contrast with relying on stored wealth and harvest. This supplies a distinct original exposition of the trust Rav Tzadok associates with the festival.

2228 **Midrash Tanchuma, Pinchas 16:1**: "A king made a feast for seven days and invited all the people of the city. When the seven days of feasting had passed, he said to his friend: We have fulfilled our obligations to all the people of the city. Let you and I manage with whatever is available—with a pound of meat, a pound of fish, or vegetables. So the Holy One said to Israel: All the offerings you brought in the seven days of the festival were for the nations of the world. But on the eighth day, you and I will manage with whatever you find—with one bull and one ram."

Context: The private meal after the public feast represents Shemini Atzeret's particular bond between God and Israel. Rav Tzadok contrasts that closeness with the separation experienced on the ninth of Av.

2229 **Numbers 29:36**: "You shall offer a burnt offering, a fire offering of pleasing aroma to Hashem: one bull, one ram, seven yearling lambs without blemish."

2230 **Deuteronomy 32:12**: 'Hashem alone guided him; no foreign god was with Him.'

2231 **Eikhah Rabbah 1:20**: "Why was the Scroll of Lamentations composed alphabetically? Rabbi Yehudah, Rabbi Nechemyah, and the Sages discussed this. Rabbi Yehudah says: Because it is written, "All Israel transgressed Your Torah," which is written from alef to tav; therefore this scroll was written in alphabetical sequences, one corresponding to the other."

Context: This is the Midrashic explanation of the alphabetical form of Eikhah invoked here. Rav Tzadok applies its alef-to-tav correspondence to the twenty-two days and letters.

2232 **Mishnah Taanit 4:6**: "Five things befell our fathers on the seventeenth of Tammuz and five on the Ninth of Av. On the seventeenth of Tammuz the Tablets were broken, the daily offering ceased, the city was breached, Apostemos burned the Torah, and an idol was set up in the Sanctuary."

The Mishnah is on Taanit 26a–b; the Gemara derives the date of the breaking of the Tablets from the verses at **Taanit 28b:8**.

2233 **Concealment prepares a fuller reception of Torah**

The growth of Oral Torah after destruction makes the transformation concrete.

Kisvei Rav Tzadok · Peri Tzadik, Matot 10:1: "This is the meaning of "between the narrow straits": there is a boundary on either side, so the concealment cannot extend before it or beyond Tisha B'Av. Repair and completion take place precisely within those concealed days. We see that after the Temple's destruction, Oral Torah began to spread and multiply through the Tannaim and Amoraim who arose afterward. The Midrash likewise says that Oral Torah is principally disclosed through pain and toil, and concerning them it says, "The people walking in darkness saw a great light.""

Explanation: Matot develops the same twenty-two-day and alphabet structure by pointing to the expansion of Oral Torah through the Tannaim and Amoraim after the destruction. This supplies a concrete counterpart to the siman's movement from a powerful vision toward acquired Torah. The comparison concerns the capacity to receive and develop the light within concealment; it does not make the destruction itself the desired final state.

2234 See note 1855 (Vol. I).

2235 **Mekhilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Tractate Shirah 3:10**: ""This is my God." Rabbi Eliezer says: From where do you

which mirrors Passover where "a maidservant saw at the Sea, etc.," וְאַחַר כָּךְ שָׁבוּעוֹת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה בְּקִנְיָן, וְצָרִיךְ מ"ט יְמֵי סְפִירָה בֵּינָתַיִם. — **and afterward Shavuot brings the Giving of the Torah in permanent acquisition, requiring forty-nine days of the Omer count in between.** וְכֵן מִי' בְּאָב עַד רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה הֵם מ"ט יְמֵי סְפִירַת נְקִיִּים, וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַתְחִיל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בְּקִנְיָן כְּפִי תִּקְוֹף הָרְאִיָּה שֶׁבֵּין הַמְּצָרִים: — **And so from the Tenth of Av until Rosh Hashanah are forty-nine clean days of counting, and afterward words of Torah commence in permanent acquisition commensurate with the intensity of the vision beheld during the Three Weeks of Bein HaMetzarim.**

Siman 172

Just as in Space There Exists the Foundation Stone (Even Shetiyah) from Which The…

כְּמוֹ [קעב][2236] שֶׁמְּמֶנּוּ הֻשְׁתְּתָה הָעוֹלָם "אֶבֶן שְׁתִיָּה" שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּמָקוֹם וְהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ כָּל הָעוֹלָם, — **Just as in space there exists the Foundation Stone (Even Shetiyah) from which the world was founded and which is the root of the entire universe,** וְכָךְ בְּנֶפֶשׁ יֵשׁ נֶפֶשׁ אַחַת שֶׁכּוֹלֶלֶת כָּל הַדּוֹר וְהוּא פַּרְנַס הַדּוֹר כַּיָּדוּעַ, וְכֵן הַכּוֹלֶלֶת כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת כַּנּוֹדָע,[2237] — **and so too in soul there exists one soul that encompasses the entire generation, namely the leader of the generation as is known, and likewise one that encompasses all generations as is known,** וְכֵן בִּזְמַן יֵשׁ זְמַן שֶׁכּוֹלֵל כָּל הַיָּמִים וְהוּא יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת — **and so too in time there exists a time that encompasses all days, which is the Sabbath day** וְקֹדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים, וּבִזְמַן שַׁבָּת וְיוֹם טוֹב, וּבִנְפָשׁוֹת מָלֶךְ וְכֹהֵן [וְכָל אֶחָד מֵאֵלּוּ חָלוּק לִשְׁנַיִם: בְּמָקוֹם יֵשׁ מִזְבֵּחַ[2238] גָּדוֹל; — **[and each of these dimensions is subdivided into two: in space there are the Altar and the Holy of Holies; in time, Shabbat and the Festivals; and in soul, the king and the High Priest;** קְדֻשַּׁת כֹּהֵן גָּדוֹל קְבִיעָא וְקַיָּימָא, שֶׁנִּבְדַּל אַהֲרֹן לְהַקְדִּישׁוֹ וְגוֹמֵר,[2239] — **the sanctity of the High Priest is fixed and permanent, for Aaron was set apart to be sanctified, etc.,** וּקְדֻשַּׁת מֶלֶךְ עַל יְדֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר: "תָּשִׂים עָלֶיךָ וְגוֹמֵר",[2240] — **while the sanctity of the king is established through Israel, as it is said: "you shall surely set a king over you, etc." (Deuteronomy 17:15),** וְכָל זְמַן שֶׁהָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל נְזוּפִים לֹא נִתְיַיחֵד וְכוּ' (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קכא:)].[2241] — **and all the**

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say that a maidservant at the sea saw what Yeshayahu and Yechezkel did not see? As it is said, “Through the prophets I use likenesses,” and, “The heavens opened, and I saw visions of God.””

Context: The Mekhilta supplies the precise comparison between revelation at the sea and prophetic visions. Rav Tzadok uses this comparison in distinguishing an initial vision from the later acquisition of Torah.

2236 **Yoma 54b:2-4**: ““It was called Shetiyah.” It was taught: Because from it the world was founded. Our Mishnah follows the view that the world was created from Zion. For it was taught: Rabbi Eliezer says: The world was created from its center, as it is said, “When the dust is poured into a solid mass and the clods cling together.” Rabbi Yehoshua says: The world was created from its sides, as it is said, “For to the snow He says: Become earth; and to the rain shower and the showers of His mighty rain.” Rabbi Yitzchak Nappacha said: The Holy One, blessed be He, cast a stone into the sea, and from it the world was founded, as it is said, “On what were its foundations sunk, or who cast its cornerstone?” The Sages say: It was created from Zion, as it is said, “A psalm of Asaf: God, God, Hashem,” and it says, “From Zion, the perfection of beauty”—from it the beauty of the world was perfected.”

Context: This is the explicit source for the Foundation Stone. The competing explanations are retained, and the Gemara identifies creation from Zion as the view followed by the Mishnah. Rav Tzadok uses that view as the model for a root that includes a whole realm.

2237 **Likkutei Maamarim, On Book of Joshua 10**: see note 1701 (Vol. I).

Context: Rav Tzadok’s fuller discussion explains what it means for one soul to include a generation, and explicitly connects the model to parents, Adam, and kingship. The statement describes the spiritual structure he is presenting; it is not an empirical ranking of every historical ruler.

2238 **Bereshit Rabbah 14:8**: ““From the earth”: Rabbi Berechyah and Rabbi Chelbo said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: He was created from the place of his atonement, as it says, “An altar of earth you shall make for Me.” The Holy One, blessed be He, said: I will create him from the place of his atonement; would that he endure!”

Context: The Midrash relates Adam’s creation to the site of the altar and atonement. It provides the distinct altar side of Rav Tzadok’s pairing of the altar with the Holy of Holies.

2239 **I Chronicles 23:13**: see note 494 (Vol. I).

Context: This is the verse quoted in shortened form. Its explicit inclusion of Aharon’s sons and the enduring priestly service supplies the textual basis for the established priestly sanctity discussed here.

2240 **Deuteronomy 17:15**: ‘You shall surely appoint over yourself a king whom Hashem your God chooses. You shall appoint a king from among your brothers; you may not place over yourself a foreign man who is not your brother.’

2241 **Bava Batra 121a:9**: see note 1910 (Vol. I).

Context: The sentence crosses the page boundary. Rav Tzadok uses the dependence of Moses’ communication on the people’s condition to illustrate the relationship between a leader and the whole community.

years Israel were under censure, divine communication was not uniquely granted to Moses (Bava Batra 121b)]. וְהַמְתָּקַת כָּל דָּבָר הוּא בְּשָׁרְשׁוֹ, **— And the sweetening of every entity takes place at its root,** וּבְשַׁבָּת יָכוֹל לְהַמְתִּיק כָּל יְמֵי הַשָּׁבוּעַ לְהִתְהַפֵּךְ לְטוֹב, כִּי בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ נָקֵל לְהַמְתִּיק כַּיָּדוּעַ בְּכָל דָּבָר. **— and on Shabbat one is able to sweeten all the days of the week so that they transform into good, for at the root it is easy to sweeten, as is known in all matters.** (מָלְכִים א ח, מח) "וְהִתְפַּלְלוּ אֵלֶיךָ דֶּרֶךְ אַרְצָם"[2242] וְהַמְתָּקַת הַמְּקוֹמוֹת הוּא עַל יְדֵי, **— And the sweetening of geographic places is achieved through "and they pray unto You toward their land" (I Kings 8:48) and toward the Holy Temple,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה אֵין מִתְדַּבְּקִים בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן מַאֲווִיר אֶרֶץ הָעַמִּים הַמְטַמֵּא חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. **— and through this, the defilement of the air of the land of the nations does not cling to him, Heaven forbid.** וְהַמְתָּקַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ בְּכָל חֶסְרוֹנוֹת שֶׁבָּהּ בַּתּוֹלָדָה – עַל יְדֵי דְּבִיקָה לְפַרְנַס הַדּוֹר, **— And the sweetening of the soul in all its congenital deficiencies is accomplished through its attachment to the leader of the generation,** כָּל זְמַן שֶׁשִּׁמְעִי בֶּן גֵּרָא קַיִּים לֹא וְכוּלִי,[2243] וּכְדִשְׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרָכוֹת ח.): **— as our Sages of blessed memory stated (Berakhot 8a): so long as Shimei ben Gera was alive, Solomon did not marry the daughter of Pharaoh;** כִּי הָאָב וְהָרַב הֵם שׁוֹרֶשׁ לְנֶפֶשׁ הַבֵּן וְהַתַּלְמִיד. **— for the father and the teacher are the spiritual root for the soul of the son and the disciple.** וּכְאָמְרָם זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּנֶפֶשׁ הָאָב: בְּיוֹסֵף, רָאָה דְּמוּת דְּיוֹקְנוֹ שֶׁל אָבִיו, וְזֶה מוֹנֵעַ מֵרַע חַס וְשָׁלוֹם.[2244] **— And as they stated regarding the soul of the father: with Joseph, he saw the visage of his father's countenance (Sotah 36b), and this restrains one from evil, Heaven forbid.** וְהַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל הוּא הָיָה נוֹשֵׂא עֲוונוֹת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל,[2245] **— And the High Priest would bear the iniquities of all Israel,** וּבְיוֹסִיפּוֹן תִּרְאֶה שֶׁקָּרָאוּהוּ הַכֹּל "הַמְכַפֵּר בְּעַד כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל", **— and in Josippon you will see that all titled him "the one who atones on behalf of all Israel,"** שֶׁמַּסִּיר כָּל מִינֵי כִּיעוּר וּמְיַפֶּה בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּכָל מִינֵי יוֹפִי, כְּעִנְיַן אַהֲרֹן שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא[2246] **— removing every form of ugliness and adorning the children of Israel with every kind of beauty, in the manner of Aaron who is the bridesman of the Queen** [וְכֵן הוּא אֲבָל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שָׁנְקְרָא הַקֹּדֶשׁ הַקְּדָשִׁים וְשַׁבָּת]. **— [and likewise is the Holy of Holies and Shabbat].** מֶלֶךְ, הוּא שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכָּא, **— But Moses our teacher, peace be upon him, who is called king, is the groomsman of the King,** לְהַרְאוֹת לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים וּמֶלֶךְ עוֹלָם. **— to reveal unto the children of Israel the light of the countenance of the King of Life and eternal Sovereign.** וְזֶהוּ קְדוּשַׁת הַיָּמִים טוֹבִים,

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[2242] **I Kings 8:48**: ‘And they return to You with all their heart and all their soul in the land of their enemies who took them captive, and pray to You toward their land, which You gave to their fathers, the city You chose, and the house I built for Your name.’

[2243] **Berakhot 8a**: ‘Rabbi Chiyya bar Ammi also said in Ulla’s name: A person should always live in the place where his teacher lives, for as long as Shimei son of Gera was alive, Solomon did not marry Pharaoh’s daughter.’

[2244] See note 1262 (Vol. I).

[2245] **Moshe reveals the King’s light; Aharon prepares Israel to receive it**

The two attendants represent distinct forms of bringing the relationship between Hashem and Israel into expression.

Kisvei Rav Tzadok · Peri Tzadik, Chanukah 8:6: “Moses and Aaron embody netzach and hod. Moses corresponds to netzach, on the right side, as Abraham made His divinity known so that He would be called God of the earth; Moses likewise brought the Divine Presence down to earth. He is the King’s attendant. Aaron embodies hod, on the left side, and is the Matron’s attendant: he atones for and adorns the Matron, the Congregation of Israel, so that she finds favor in God’s eyes. The entire sacrificial service and the holiness of Yom Kippur operate through Aaron the priest. Yet the Zohar also says that the priest comes from kindness. This follows “For the priest’s lips preserve knowledge”: knowledge joins right and left, wisdom and understanding, mind and heart.”

Explanation: Chanukah spells out the imagery used here: Moshe makes the divine presence known below, while Aharon atones for and adorns the congregation so that it can find favor. This makes the siman’s two functions intelligible rather than treating king and High Priest as interchangeable encompassing figures. Its closing qualification also matters: the priest’s knowledge joins right and left, so the roles remain distinct without becoming disconnected powers.

[2246] **Zohar, Metzora 7:23-24**: “Come and see: What is the difference between Moshe and Aharon? Which of them is higher? Moshe is higher. Moshe is the attendant of the King; Aharon is the attendant of the Queen. It is like a king who had an exalted queen. What did he do? He gave her an attendant to prepare her and attend to the affairs of the household. Therefore, when this attendant enters before the king, he enters only with the queen. This is what is written: “With this shall Aharon enter.” Moshe is the attendant of the King; therefore he was invited as a guest, and afterward, “Hashem spoke to him.” Aharon is the attendant of the Queen, and all his affairs are to reconcile the King with the Queen, so that the King is reconciled with her. Therefore, because he is her attendant, he established his dwelling with her, to prepare the household and attend continually to its affairs. Accordingly he was appointed after the pattern above and called High Priest. From where do we know this? As it is written, “You are a priest forever, according to My word, Malki-Tzedek.””

Context: The original Zohar passage gives the household parable and explains Aharon’s work of preparation and reconciliation. It adds that explanation to the terminology already used in the connected source, and clarifies the distinction Rav Tzadok draws between the two forms of spiritual leadership.

And this is the sanctity of the Festivals; וּבִפְרָט זֶה בְּהַשָּׂגוֹת אוֹר הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, הַהַמְשָׁכָה לְכָל הַשָּׁנָה הוּא מֵהָרְגָלִים שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר "יֵרָאֶה וְגוֹמֵר אֶת פְּנֵי וְגוֹמֵר" (שְׁמוֹת לד, כג): בָּהֶם[2247] **— and specifically in this—in the perceptions of the light of the Blessed Name—the continuous drawing down for the entire year derives from the pilgrimage festivals, concerning which it is stated: "all your males shall appear before the face of the Lord God, etc." (Exodus 34:23).**

Siman 173

All Natural Phenomena Fulfill the Will of the Blessed Name

All natural phenomena fulfill the will of the Blessed Name, as it is written: "Hashem has made everything for His own purpose" (Proverbs 16:4)—meaning for His praise; כָּל הַדְּבָרִים הַטִּבְעִיִּים הֵם עוֹשִׂים רְצוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ, כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב: "כֹּל פָּעַל ה' לַמַּעֲנֵהוּ" (מִשְׁלֵי טז, ד) [קעג][2248] – לְקִילּוּסוֹ,[2249] — וְאָמְרוּ בְּחֻלִּין (ז.):[2250] בְּגִינַאי נַהֲרָא, אֲנִי הוֹלֵךְ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹן קוֹנִי – מַה שֶּׁהוּא בְּטִבְעוֹ כָּךְ [וּלְפִיכָךְ גַּם] — **and they stated in Chullin 7a regarding the river Ginai: "I am going to perform the will of my Maker," which is simply its natural flowing**; הָאָדָם, כְּשֶׁעוֹשֶׂה מַעֲשִׂים הַטִּבְעִיִּים שֶׁהוּא מֻכְרָח בָּהֶם מִצַּד טִבְעוֹ, נִקְרָא הוֹלֵךְ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹן קוֹנוֹ וְיֵשׁ מִצְוָה בַּדָּבָר; **[and therefore a human being as well, when engaging in natural actions to which he is compelled by his physical nature, is considered going to perform the will of his Maker, and a mitzvah resides in the matter;** וּבִכְלָל גַּם כֵּן אֲכִילָה וּשְׁתִיָּה וְזִוּוּג, שֶׁהוּא בְּטֶבַע כְּבָכָל בַּעֲלֵי חַיִּים הַטִּבְעִיִּים שֶׁאֵינָם בְּחִירִיִּים; **— and this includes eating, drinking, and marital intimacy, which are natural as in all animals that do not possess free choice;** וּבִלְבַד מַה שֶּׁהוּא בְּהֶכְרֵחַ, כְּגוֹן אֲכִילָה לְרַעֲבוֹן,[2251] **— provided it is done out of necessity, such as eating to**

2247 **Exodus 34:23**: “Three times in the year all your males shall appear before the face of the Master, Hashem, the God of Israel.”

Context: The words “et penei” quoted here are from this verse; Exodus 23:17 reads “el penei.”

2248 **Proverbs 16:4**: ‘Hashem has made everything for His sake, even the wicked for the day of evil.’

2249 **Each creature can supply a particular lesson**

The powers distributed through creation can teach different aspects of human service.

Kisvei Ishbitz–Radzin · Tiferet Yosef, Ha'azinu and Shabbat Shuvah 11: ““When the Most High apportioned nations… He set the boundaries of peoples according to the number of Israel, for Hashem's portion is His people.” Hashem grants great powers to the nations too, and precious powers are found in all kinds of creatures. The Gemara interprets “He teaches us from the beasts of the earth and makes us wise from the birds”: had Torah not been given, we would learn modesty from the cat, avoidance of theft from the ant, fidelity from the dove and proper conduct from the rooster. Great powers can likewise sometimes be found among the nations exceeding Israel's, for Israel is described as “the fewest of all peoples” (Deuteronomy 7:7); all the more are great powers found among the heavenly hosts. Yet the principal point is “Hashem's portion is His people; Yaakov is the rope of His inheritance”: the whole is directed toward Israel.”

Explanation: Tiferet Yosef explains the same verse about learning from animals by naming distinct virtues in different creatures. Their particular powers may exceed a person's present achievement in that respect. This clarifies the siman's move from natural action to chosen learning: a person recognizes the lesson and brings it into his own service, while the siman itself supplies the conditions of necessary bodily life and sanctifying the Name.

2250 **Chullin 7a**: ‘He said to it: ‘Ginnai, divide your waters for me so that I can cross through you!’ It answered: ‘You are going to carry out your Creator’s will, and I am going to carry out my Creator’s will. You may carry it out, or you may not; I certainly carry it out.’ He told it: ‘If you do not divide, I decree that water will never pass through you again.’ It divided for him.’

2251 **Natural necessity and surplus desire**

The same river comparison distinguishes the needs built into human nature from further desires.

Kisvei Rav Tzadok · Dover Tzedek, Miscellany 4:64: “After the giving of Torah they knew that Hashem's will includes what a person needs. As Chullin 7a says of the river Ginai, ‘I am going to fulfill my Creator's will’: the nature implanted in it is its Creator's will, like a mitzvah. Likewise, what a person naturally needs for eating and drinking is the Creator's will and a mitzvah. They knew this through Torah's gift, called a complete gift: this gift belongs to them from their hidden root. Such is Torah's way—bread with salt and measured water, only what is necessary. Through this their hidden root became known to them. They still remained uncertain concerning the expansion and surplus of desires. This applies only to the fruits of the land, through mitzvot: when a person performs a mitzvah with bread or food, Heaven's name rests upon that expansion itself, in the manner of the land of Israel. As I wrote elsewhere, this is the secret of the blessing over enjoyment that the Sages instituted before every enjoyment; this is not the place to explain it. Through this their hidden root became known to them in this too.”

Explanation: Dover Tzedek uses the same encounter with the river to explain why meeting a genuine natural need can fulfill the Creator's will. It then explicitly distinguishes surplus desire, which requires a further clarification through mitzvot. This keeps the siman's restriction to what is necessary beside its broad statement about natural service.

satisfy hunger, וְכֵן בְּזִוּוּג עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ם כְּשֶׁמּוֹצֵא וְכוּ', דְּהַטֶּבַע תּוֹבְעוֹ לְכָךְ,[2252] **— and so too in intimacy, in line with what Maimonides wrote: when he senses, etc., that nature demands it of him,** וְכַיּוֹצֵא בּוֹ בִּיהוּדָה רֶמֶז לַמַּלְאָךְ הַמְמוּנֶּה וְכוּ', וְעַיֵּן בְּמוֹרֶה נְבוּכִים (פֶּרֶק ו מַחֲלֹק ב);[2253] שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פָּרָשָׁה פה)[2254] **— and similar to this with Judah, concerning whom our Sages expounded (Bereishit Rabbah 85:8) that it was a hint to the angel appointed over desire, etc., and see Guide for the Perplexed (Part II, chapter 6);** וְלִהְיוֹת מְכַוִּין לְכָךְ רַק בִּשְׁבִיל רְצוֹן קוֹנוֹ שֶׁבָּרָאוֹ כֵּן,[2255] **— and intending it solely for the sake of the will of his Maker Who created him thus,** (כ:): זֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּנְדָרִים[2256] דּוֹמֶה לְמִי שֶׁכְּפָאוֹ וְכוּ', וְזֶהוּ רְצוֹן קוֹנוֹ]. **— which is what they stated in Nedarim 20b: comparable to one compelled by a demon, and that is the will of his Maker].** וּבְזֹהַר פִּינְחָס (רכב עמוד ב) וּבְפֶרֶק שִׁירָה, דְּצִפַּרְדֵּעַ אָמְרָה לְדָוִד שֶׁהִיא מְקַלֶּסֶת יוֹמָם וָלַיְלָה לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ,[2257] **— And in Zohar Pinchas (222b) and in Perek Shirah, the frog said to David that it sings praises day and night to the Blessed Name,** הֲרֵי פְּעֻלָּתָהּ[2258] וְהַיְינוּ דְּמַה שֶּׁצּוֹוַחַת בְּקוֹלָהּ, כֵּינָן דְּהַכֹּל לְמַעֲנֵהוּ – לְקִילּוּסוֹ (שׁוֹחֵר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים קמח), תְּמִידִית לְקִילּוּס לַהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **— meaning that its continuous croaking, since everything is for His purpose— for His praise (Shocher Tov, Psalm 148)—is an uninterrupted act of praising the Blessed Name.** וְצָרִיךְ

2252 **Mishneh Torah, Human Dispositions 4:19**: "He should have intercourse only when he finds his body exceptionally healthy and strong, and he has a strong involuntary erection; he diverts his attention to something else, yet the erection remains as before; he feels heaviness from his loins downward, as though the cords of the testicles were being drawn, and his flesh is hot. Such a person needs intercourse, and intercourse is a remedy for him."

Context: This is the passage Rav Tzadok abbreviates as "when he finds." It belongs to Rambam's historical regimen of bodily health and supplies the particular case of bodily necessity intended by the citation.

2253 **Bereshit Rabbah 85:8**: ""Judah saw her and thought her to be a harlot, because she covered her face" (Genesis 38:15). "Judah saw her" – Rabbi Ḥiyya bar Zavda said: A person must be very careful regarding his wife's sister and his female relatives, that he not stumble with one of them. From whom do you derive it? From Judah – "Judah saw her…" Why? It is "because she covered her face" while she was still in her father-in-law's house. "He turned to her by the road, and he said: Please, let me consort with you, for he did not know that she was his daughter-in-law. She said: What will you give me that you would consort with me" (Genesis 38:16)? Another matter: "Judah saw her" – he did not pay attention to her. When she covered her face, he said: Were she a harlot, would she have covered her face? Rabbi Yoḥanan said: He sought to pass, but the Holy One blessed be He dispatched to him the angel that is responsible for desire. He said to him: 'Judah, where are you going? From where will kings be produced, from where will the prominent ones be produced?' "He turned to her by the road" – despite himself, against his will."

2254 **Guide for the Perplexed, Part 2 6:4**: "In the section concerning Judah and Tamar, it says: "Rabbi Yochanan said: He sought to pass by, but the Holy One, blessed be He, appointed for him an angel in charge of desire"—meaning the power of sexual arousal. Thus it calls this power too an angel. … Every power that God, exalted be He, appoints over a thing is an angel appointed over that thing."

Context: Maimonides expressly interprets the angel in the Judah and Tamar Midrash as a natural faculty. This is the explanation Rav Tzadok directs the reader to consult, after citing the Midrash itself.

2255 **Mishneh Torah, Human Dispositions 3:3**: see note 12 (Vol. I).

Context: Rambam explicitly connects necessary bodily activity with intention for divine service, extending the principle even to sleep. This supplies a parallel original formulation of the intention Rav Tzadok requires here.

2256 **Nedarim 20b**: 'But they raised a contradiction: They asked Imma Shalom: Why are your children exceptionally beautiful? She told them: He is not intimate with me at the beginning of the night or at the end of the night, but only at midnight. When he is intimate, he uncovers a handbreadth and covers a handbreadth, and he is like someone compelled by a demon.'

2257 **Zohar, Pinchas 64:380**: "He too opened and said: "Hashem, my heart was not proud, nor were my eyes raised." David said this verse when he was walking along a riverbank, saying: "Master of the world, is there a person in the world who gives thanks and praises his Master as I do?" A frog appeared before him and said: "David, do not be proud, for I have done more than you: I gave my body for my Master's command, as it is written, 'The river shall swarm with frogs,' as has been explained. Moreover, I praise and sing day and night without ceasing." At that moment David said: "Hashem, my heart was not proud, nor were my eyes raised.""

Context: The Zohar's complete exchange joins the frog's continual praise to its surrender of its body at God's command. Both elements are needed for Rav Tzadok's progression from natural activity to learning self-sacrifice from the frogs of Egypt.

2258 **Midrash Tehillim 148:2**: "The Holy One, blessed be He, created the human being only for His glory. So it says, "The Lord has made everything for His purpose." He created them to praise Him, and they praised Him, as it says, "The heavens declare." Just as the heavens and all within them praise Him, so the earth and all within it praise Him."

Context: Shocher Tov is another name for Midrash Tehillim. This passage interprets "for His purpose" as praise, which is the connection Rav Tzadok invokes when describing the frog's ongoing natural activity.